FIELD GUIDE

Emergency Preparedness & Outdoor Skills

Water · Food · Shelter · Survival Skills
Hunting, Trapping & Fishing · Wild Game Recipes



PREPARED FOR A TWO-PERSON HOUSEHOLD

Plan for 90 days. Practice before you need it.

Contents

Page numbers refer to the numbers printed in each page footer. Recipes are listed in Appendix A, diagrams in Appendix B, and urgent topics in Appendix C.

Part 1: The Plan 2
- Read This First 2
- Phase 1: Now (Days 1 to 30) 2
- Phase 2: Intermediate (Months 1 to 6): Reusable Water and Resilience 3
- Phase 3: Long-Term Living (6+ Months) 4

Part 2: Food and Water 6
- Grocery Lists (Two Adults) 6
- Water Treatment Instructions 8
- Activated Charcoal and Charcoal Water Filters 8
- Food Safety During an Outage 10
- Long-Term Meat Storage (Off-Grid) 10

Part 3: Survival Skills 13
- 1. Fire 13
- 2. Water 13
- 3. Shelter 13
- 4. First aid and medical response 14
- 5. Knots 14
- 6. Signaling 14
- 7. Food: preservation, cooking, and foraging 15
- 8. Sanitation and hygiene 15
- 9. Tools, repairs, and maintenance 15
- 10. Security and awareness 15
- 11. Planning, routines, and morale 16

Part 4: Communication and Navigation 17
- Morse Code 17
- Map Reading and Navigation 18
- Coordinate Word Code (8-Digit Grid Reference) 24
- Family Contact Plan (Paper Copy) 26
- Skill Practice Checklist 26

Part 5: Hunting, Trapping, and Fishing 27
- Hunting, Gutting, Skinning, and Quartering 27
- Taking the Meat Off Each Animal 32
- Trapping 34
- Fishing and Fish Cleaning 38
- Game Food Safety and Cooking Temperatures 39

Part 6: Recipes 41
- Emergency Cookbook (Pantry Recipes) 41
- Wild Game Recipes 46

Part 7: Safety and Reference 52
- Safety Reference 52
- Rotation and Maintenance Schedule 52
- Cooking and Water Quick Reference 52

Appendix A: Recipe Index 53

Appendix B: Diagram Index 53

Appendix C: Quick-Find for Urgent Topics 54

How to use this guide. Start with Part 1 and work through its checklists in order. Parts 2 to 5 hold the detail behind them. Use Part 6 when you cook, and keep Part 7 with your supplies. The appendices at the back tell you where to find any recipe, diagram, or urgent topic.

Part 1: The Plan

What to do, and in what order: now, over the first months, and for the long term.

Read This First

What a long outage realistically means: no electricity for weeks or months, pumps and water systems failing, stores emptying within days, no fuel deliveries, phones and internet down, and some electronics damaged. This plan covers all of those effects. Plan for **3 months** as the goal and **2 weeks** as the minimum.

> **Three rules:**
>
> 1. Store what you eat, and eat what you store. Rotate so nothing expires on the shelf.
> 2. Never run a generator, grill, camp stove, or propane heater indoors or in a garage. They produce carbon monoxide. Install battery-backup CO detectors.
> 3. Write things down on paper. Phones, cloud accounts, and apps may not work.

Household numbers (2 adults)

Item	2 weeks	90 days
Water	28 gallons (1 gal per person per day)	180 gallons
Calories	About 4,000 per day total	About 4,000 per day total

Grocery quantities below are already doubled for two people.

Phase 1: Now (Days 1 to 30)

- ☐ **Water:** Store 28 gallons (about four 7-gallon jugs, or equivalent cases of bottled water).
- ☐ **Food:** Buy the 2-week starter list (see Grocery lists).
- ☐ **Medicine:** Ask your doctor or pharmacy about a 30-day supply of every prescription for both of you. Keep copies of prescriptions. Build a shared OTC kit: pain reliever, antihistamine, anti-diarrheal, oral rehydration salts, antacid, and any personal medications.
- ☐ **Cash:** Keep $300 to $500 in small bills. ATMs and card readers fail in outages.
- ☐ **Light and power:** Two LED headlamps, two flashlights, spare batteries in a dated bin, at least one hand-crank or battery AM/FM radio, and fully charged power banks.
- ☐ **Fuel:** Keep vehicles at least half full. Store a small amount of stabilized fuel in approved containers, following local limits.
- ☐ **Documents:** Copies of IDs, insurance cards, property records, and bank and medical contacts. Keep them in a waterproof bag, on a USB drive, and in a secure cloud account.

- ☐ **Sanitation:** Toilet paper, heavy-duty trash bags, unscented plain bleach, soap, hand sanitizer, and a 5-gallon bucket with a lid for a backup toilet (bags plus kitty litter or sawdust).
- ☐ **Cooking:** A portable camp stove or propane burner for outdoor use only, with fuel, matches, a lighter, and fire starters.
- ☐ **Warmth and shelter:** One sleeping bag or blanket per person, warm layers, and a tarp.
- ☐ **Communication plan:** Choose one out-of-area contact everyone calls. Pick two meeting places (one near home, one outside the neighborhood). Print a contact list.
- ☐ **Pets (if any):** Two weeks of food, water, medication, and records.
- ☐ **Rotation system:** Label every item with its purchase date. Put new items at the back and use the oldest first.
- ☐ **Backup radio:** Keep one older battery radio with no chips (many simple AM/FM radios qualify). Store it with spare batteries in a metal container, such as a metal ammo can or a metal trash can with a tight lid. This is a cheap backup, not a guaranteed shield.

Phase 2: Intermediate (Months 1 to 6): Reusable Water and Resilience

Water source

- ☐ **Gravity filter:** Buy a countertop or gravity filter with third-party certification. Look for NSF/ANSI standards that match your concerns, including microbiological reduction. Choose one that makes at least 2 gallons per day.
- ☐ **Portable filter:** Hollow-fiber filters (such as Sawyer-type) remove bacteria and protozoa but not viruses. Keep one per person for travel and emergencies.
- ☐ **Chemical backup:** Chlorine dioxide tablets treat water for bacteria and viruses. Store them cool and dry, and check expiration dates.
- ☐ **Rain catchment:** Install a food-grade rain barrel with a first-flush diverter and a screened lid. Treat before drinking.
- ☐ **Water heater reserve:** Learn how to shut off power and gas to the water heater, then drain it from the bottom to recover 30 to 80 gallons.
- ☐ **Local sources:** Map nearby streams, ponds, and lakes, and know how to treat their water.

Food

- ☐ Expand to the **90-day pantry** using the full list.
- ☐ Add freeze-dried meals and canned meat for variety.
- ☐ Set up shelving with containers that protect against pests and moisture.
- ☐ Store grains and beans in food-grade buckets with oxygen absorbers.

Cooking without power

- ☐ Practice cooking one full meal on your camp stove or rocket stove outdoors. Time it and track how much fuel it uses.
- ☐ Try a solar oven (optional, works in sunny climates).
- ☐ Buy extra fuel: propane, white gas, or wood.

Power

- ☐ Get a portable power station or a small solar kit with a battery. Size it for phones, radios, lights, and a small fridge for part of the day.
- ☐ If you own a generator, run it outdoors at least 20 feet from windows and doors, and store enough fuel for 1 to 2 weeks of planned use.

Communication and information

- ☐ Buy a NOAA weather radio.
- ☐ Consider GMRS or ham radio (GMRS requires an FCC license; ham requires passing an FCC exam).
- ☐ Print local maps and your evacuation routes.

Skills and training

- ☐ Take a first aid and CPR course (Red Cross or local equivalent). Both of you should be certified.
- ☐ Practice the skills in Parts 3 and 4.
- ☐ Run one "power off" weekend drill. Note what fails and what you're missing.

Sanitation and security

- ☐ Set up a sealed bucket toilet system and a trash plan.
- ☐ Add door bars, motion lights, and secure storage for valuables and important papers.

Phase 3: Long-Term Living (6+ Months)

Food production

- ☐ **Garden:** Grow calorie crops (potatoes, beans, squash, corn, sweet potatoes) and leafy greens suited to your region.
- ☐ **Seeds:** Buy open-pollinated or heirloom seeds so you can save seed from your harvest. Store extra seed cool and dry.
- ☐ **Perennials:** Plant fruit and nut trees, berry bushes, and herbs.
- ☐ **Preservation:** A pressure canner (required for low-acid foods like beans, meat, and vegetables), a food dehydrator, and a fermentation crock. Learn tested recipes from an official source before you start.
- ☐ **Animals:** Chickens or rabbits, if zoning and local rules allow.

Water

- ☐ Drill or access a well with a hand-pump backup, or add a solar-powered pump.
- ☐ Set up a multi-stage filtration system that handles your local water.
- ☐ Reuse greywater (from washing, not toilets) on the garden where local rules allow.

Energy and heat

- ☐ Install a solar array with battery storage sized for essentials.
- ☐ Set up a winter heat source: a wood stove with a safe chimney, or a propane heater rated for indoor use with proper ventilation and CO detection.
- ☐ Insulate, weatherproof, and seal the living space.

Medical

- ☐ Work with your doctor on extended prescriptions where allowed.
- ☐ Stock wound care (gauze, tape, antiseptic, a suture kit only with training), dental supplies, and spare eyeglasses.
- ☐ Get a field medicine reference book.

Community and finance

- ☐ Build a local network of neighbors with complementary skills (medical, mechanical, farming, carpentry).
- ☐ Keep a cash reserve and barter goods (salt, coffee, batteries, soap, matches, tools).

Maintenance and tools

- ☐ Stock hand tools, spare parts, and fuel for manual equipment. Learn to sharpen tools and repair clothing.

Part 2: Food and Water

What to buy, how to treat and filter water, how to handle an outage, and how to keep meat.

Grocery Lists (Two Adults)

Starter list: 2 weeks

Item	Qty	Notes
White rice	20 lb	Long-lasting when sealed
Dry pinto or black beans	10 lb	Canned beans save fuel
Rolled oats	6 lb	Breakfast
Pasta	4 lb	
Canned chicken or tuna	24 (5 oz) cans	Main protein
Canned beans (black or pinto)	8 cans	
Canned vegetables (corn, green beans, carrots, mixed)	16 cans	
Canned fruit	8 cans	
Peanut butter	4 lb	
All-purpose flour	10 lb	Flatbread, pancakes, cobbler
Powdered milk (nonfat dry)	4 lb	
Cooking oil	2 quarts	
Honey	2 jars	Almost unlimited shelf life
Sugar	4 lb	
Salt	1 large canister	
Bouillon cubes or powder	2 jars	
Baking powder	2 cans	
Baking soda	1 box	
Dried fruit	4 lb	
Lentils, dry	2 lb	Quick-cooking protein
Dehydrated potato flakes	2 lb	Chowders and hash
Textured vegetable protein (dry)	1 lb	Taco filling
Seasonings	Chili powder, cumin, garlic powder, onion powder, cinnamon, black pepper	1 each
Multivitamins	1 bottle	
Water	28 gallons	

Full 90-day list

Category	Item	Qty
Grains	White rice	100 lb
Grains	Rolled oats	20 lb
Grains	Pasta	20 lb
Grains	All-purpose flour	20 lb
Protein	Dry pinto, black beans, or lentils	50 lb (mix)
Protein	Canned chicken, tuna, or salmon	60 cans
Protein	Canned beans	24 cans
Protein	Textured vegetable protein (dry)	4 lb
Protein	Peanut butter	8 lb
Vegetables	Canned vegetables	60 cans
Vegetables	Dehydrated potato flakes	10 lb
Fruit	Canned fruit	30 cans
Fruit	Dried fruit	10 lb
Dairy	Powdered milk	10 lb
Fats	Cooking oil	2 gallons
Sweeteners	Honey	10 lb
Sweeteners	Sugar	10 lb
Seasoning	Salt, bouillon, chili powder, cumin, garlic powder, onion powder, cinnamon, black pepper	Enough for 90 days
Baking	Baking powder, baking soda, yeast	1 each
Beverages	Instant coffee or tea	1 jar or box
Supplements	Multivitamins	1 bottle
Water	Bottled or stored	180 gallons

Storage notes

- White rice, dry beans, and oats keep for years when sealed in food-grade buckets with oxygen absorbers. Brown rice goes rancid in about six months, so skip it for long-term storage.
- Store everything in a cool, dark, dry place, ideally below about 70°F.
- Oil and peanut butter have shorter shelf lives. Buy them in sizes you'll use within a year.
- Commercially bottled water is safe until its printed date. Home-stored tap water should be replaced about every 6 months.
- 180 gallons of water weighs roughly 1,500 pounds. Spread it across sturdy shelving or multiple containers, and check that the floor can carry the load.

Sample daily meal plan (two adults, about 4,000 calories total)

- **Breakfast:** Oatmeal with powdered milk, dried fruit, honey, and peanut butter.
- **Lunch:** Tuna and bean salad (no-cook), or chicken with peanut butter and honey on flatbread.
- **Dinner:** Rice and bean chili, or lentil soup, with canned vegetables and bouillon.
- **Snack:** Peanut butter and honey energy bars.

Rice and beans together provide complete protein. Canned meat, peanut butter, and lentils add more protein and fat.

Water Treatment Instructions

Boiling (most reliable):

- Bring water to a rolling boil and hold it for 1 minute.
- At elevations above about 6,500 feet, boil for 3 minutes.
- Let it cool in a covered container.

Unscented plain liquid bleach (5% to 9% sodium hypochlorite):

- Add 8 drops per gallon of clear water, or 16 drops if the water is cloudy.
- Stir and let stand for 30 minutes.
- The water should smell faintly of chlorine. If it doesn't, repeat the dose and wait another 15 minutes.
- Never use scented, color-safe, or cleaning bleach. Never mix bleach with ammonia or other cleaners.

Filters and tablets: Follow the manufacturer's directions. Replace filter cartridges on schedule. A charcoal filter improves taste and removes some chemicals but does not make water safe to drink. See Activated Charcoal and Charcoal Water Filters below.

Activated Charcoal and Charcoal Water Filters

Activated charcoal (activated carbon) is carbon with millions of tiny pores. Contaminants stick to its surface, which is why it is used in water filters and gas filters. Know what it does well, and what it does not do.

What it is good for

- **Improving water:** Removes bad taste, odor, chlorine, many pesticides, and many organic chemicals. Use it as one stage of a filter, together with sand and gravel.
- **Odor control:** Absorbs smells and some moisture around stored food, in waste buckets, in boots, and in closed containers.
- **Air filtering:** Used in filters for some fumes and vapors. It does *not* stop carbon monoxide.
- **Gardening:** Crushed charcoal mixed into compost or soil (biochar) holds water and nutrients.

- **Poisoning (medical only):** Hospitals use medical-grade activated charcoal for certain swallowed poisons or overdoses. Call Poison Control (1-800-222-1222 in the US) or emergency services first, and give it only when they tell you to.

> **What it does not do:** It does not make water safe from bacteria, viruses, or parasites. It does not remove salt, nitrates, or fluoride, and it is poor at removing most heavy metals. It does not work on alcohol, acids, alkalis, iron, or lithium poisoning. Claims that it "detoxes" the body, cures hangovers, or whitens teeth are not supported by good evidence. **Never swallow homemade charcoal.** Always boil or disinfect water as well (see Water Treatment Instructions above).

How to make charcoal at home

1. **Pick the wood:** Use dry, untreated hardwood such as oak, hickory, maple, or fruit wood, or coconut shell or bamboo. Never use treated, painted, or glued wood, plywood, or charcoal briquettes. They release toxic fumes and chemicals.
2. **Cut small:** Cut pieces to about 1 to 2 inches thick and fit them into a metal can or steel container with a lid. Punch one small vent hole (about 1/8 inch) in the lid.
3. **Heat with little air:** Set the sealed can in a hot fire, outdoors only. Smoke and flammable gas will come out of the hole. When the smoke thins out and the gas flame at the hole dies, usually after 1 to 2 hours, the wood is charred.
4. **Cool sealed:** Pull the can from the fire with tongs and plug the hole with a stick or clay. Let it cool completely before opening, or the charcoal will catch fire when air gets in.
5. **Crush and sort:** Wearing a dust mask and gloves, crush it to pea-sized pieces for filters, and to smaller grains if you want more surface area. Rinse out the black dust.
6. **Clean and dry:** Boil the crushed charcoal in clean water for 10 to 15 minutes, drain, and repeat 2 or 3 times to wash out ash and tars. Dry it in the sun or an oven at a low setting. Store it in a sealed jar.

Build a simple charcoal water filter

1. Cut the bottom off a plastic bottle and turn it upside down in a stand, cap off (or with a small hole in the cap).
2. Layer from the bottom: a clean cloth, 2 inches of fine sand, 2 to 3 inches of crushed charcoal, 2 inches of coarse sand, then 1 to 2 inches of small gravel on top.
3. Pour 2 or 3 bottles of clean water through first to flush out dust, and throw that water away.
4. Pour your water through slowly. Then boil it for 1 minute (3 minutes above 6,500 feet), or treat it with bleach as described under Water Treatment Instructions.
5. Replace the charcoal and sand every few days of heavy use, or when the water starts to smell or taste again.

Food Safety During an Outage

- A closed refrigerator keeps food cold for about 4 hours. A full freezer keeps food frozen for about 48 hours (about 24 hours if half full). Keep the doors shut.
- Throw out perishable food that has been above 40°F for more than 2 hours.
- Discard cans that are bulging, leaking, or deeply dented, or that spray when opened.
- When in doubt, throw it out.

Long-Term Meat Storage (Off-Grid)

Meat is the hardest food to keep without power. The methods below are ranked by how well they work with no electricity. Use more than one method so a single failure doesn't leave you with nothing.

> **Food safety first:** Improvised home curing, smoking, and canning cause botulism when they go wrong. Use only USDA-tested recipes and times. Never can meat in a water bath canner. Never guess at salt or cure amounts.

Methods compared

Method	Power needed	Typical shelf life	Best for
Pressure canning	None (stove or propane burner)	Safe for years if seals stay intact; best quality within about 1 year	Your most reliable off-grid method
Dehydrating or jerky	Low (dehydrator) or none (sun or low oven)	About 1 to 2 months at room temperature in sealed containers; longer if vacuum-packed and kept cool	Lightweight protein for travel and daily use
Salt curing (tested recipes)	None	Months, depending on cut and conditions	Pork and game when you have a tested recipe and a cool, dry place
Fat sealing (confit or pemmican)	None to low	Months, if fat fully covers the meat and the jar stays cool	Dense, calorie-rich food
Freezing	Continuous	Safe indefinitely at 0°F; best quality within 6 to 12 months	Short-term use while power lasts, or with solar backup
Root cellar or cold storage	None	Days to weeks for fresh meat; not a long-term method	Keeping fresh meat for a few days after a kill

Recommended plan by phase

- ☐ **Phase 1 (now):** Store commercially canned meat and tuna (already on the starter list). These are shelf-stable with no processing needed.
- ☐ **Phase 2 (months 1 to 6):** Add a chest freezer or a deep freezer with a solar backup, and practice making jerky with a dehydrator. Vacuum-seal portions and store in a cool, dark place.
- ☐ **Phase 3 (6+ months):** Learn pressure canning with a USDA-tested recipe and a dial-gauge or weighted-gauge canner. Add salt curing and fat sealing as backups, and smoking if you have a smoker. Keep a root cellar or cool storage for fresh meat.

Quantity target (two adults, 90 days)

Plan for about 1/4 lb of preserved meat per person per day as a supplement to the beans, lentils, and canned protein in the pantry. That's about **45 lb of preserved meat** for 90 days, which can be split among jerky, canned meat, and fat-sealed meat. Adjust for what you hunt, fish for, or raise.

Method details

1. Pressure canning

- **Equipment:** A pressure canner (not a pressure cooker), jars rated for canning, new lids every time, and a dial gauge tested yearly or a weighted gauge.
- **Method:** Pack raw or hot meat into clean jars, leaving the headspace specified in the tested recipe. Add broth or water if the recipe calls for it. Wipe rims, place lids, and process at the pressure and time in the USDA recipe for your altitude.
- **Altitude:** Pressure must rise with elevation. Use the altitude adjustment in your canner's manual.
- **Check seals:** Lids should be concave and not flex when pressed after cooling. Store unsealed jars in the fridge and eat them first.

2. Jerky and dehydrated meat

- Use lean meat only. Trim all visible fat, which goes rancid quickly.
- Heat strips to 160°F before drying, as USDA guidance recommends (see recipe W14 in Part 6).
- Dry until firm and leathery with no moisture pockets. Cool completely before packing.
- Store in airtight jars or vacuum-sealed bags with an oxygen absorber in a cool, dark place. Freeze any you won't use within a few months.

3. Salt curing (tested recipes only)

- Use a published tested cure recipe for the exact cut. Pork belly, ham, and salt pork are the most common home cures, but the amounts and times matter.
- Keep the meat cold during curing and dry it in a cool place with air movement (a cellar or shaded, screened space).

- Store cured meat wrapped in cloth or paper in a cool, dry place, away from pests. Check for mold and off smells each month.

4. Fat sealing (confit and pemmican)

- **Confit:** Cook meat slowly in its own rendered fat until tender, pack into jars, and cover with fat so no meat is exposed. Store in a cool, dark place. Keep the seal intact.
- **Pemmican:** Mix finely crushed dried meat with rendered fat (tallow or lard) and dried fruit. Pack firmly into jars or sealed tins. Store cool and dry.
- If the fat cracks, discolors, or smells rancid, discard the contents.

5. Freezing (with power backup)

- A full chest freezer keeps food frozen for about 48 hours without power, or about 24 hours if half full. Keep it closed.
- Pair the freezer with a solar kit or a generator you can run outdoors, and store enough fuel for a planned 1 to 2 weeks.
- Wrap in freezer paper or vacuum-sealed bags, label with date and cut, and rotate oldest first.

6. Smoking

- Cold smoking and hot smoking both need careful control. Use a tested recipe and a thermometer.
- Smoked meat is not shelf-stable on its own. Freeze it, can it under a tested recipe, or dry it fully.
- Never smoke indoors. Keep the smoker outdoors and well away from buildings.

Storage conditions and rotation

- Store all preserved meat cool (ideally below about 70°F), dark, dry, and away from pests and moisture.
- Label every jar, bag, and tin with the contents and the date. Use oldest first.
- Inspect monthly: check jar seals, fat caps, bag seals, and any signs of mold, swelling, or off smells. When in doubt, throw it out.
- Keep a written log of what you preserved, when, which recipe you used, and when to eat it by.

Equipment checklist

- ☐ Pressure canner with a tested gauge, plus canning jars, bands, and new lids
- ☐ Food dehydrator, or a low oven and wire racks
- ☐ Vacuum sealer and bags, oxygen absorbers, and food-grade buckets or mylar bags
- ☐ Chest freezer and a backup power source
- ☐ Meat thermometer (accurate to 160°F and 145°F)
- ☐ Labels, a marker, and a rotation log

Part 3: Survival Skills

Practice each skill at home before you need it. Signals and maps are in Part 4.

Reading about these skills is not enough. Practice each one at home or in a park before you need it. Take in-person classes where you can, especially for first aid, water, and fire.

1. Fire Learn now

Fire gives warmth, cooked food, purified water, and morale.

- **Tinder, kindling, fuel:** Build a tinder bundle (dry grass, shredded bark, cotton or lint). Add pencil-thin kindling, then pencil-to-thumb-thick sticks.
- **Fire starting:** Use a ferro rod (a striker against a metal rod), a waterproof match, or a lighter. Keep at least two ways to start a fire in your kit.
- **Fire lay:** Teepee for quick heat, log cabin for steady cooking, and a dakota pit (two holes linked underground) for wind.
- **Safety:** Clear a 10-foot circle, keep water nearby, and never leave a fire unattended. Put it out until it's cold to the touch: drown, stir, and check.
- **Indoor fire:** Use only fireplaces and stoves with proper venting and CO detection.

2. Water Learn now

- **Find water:** Look for wildlife trails and low ground in valleys. Dig a hole in a dry riverbed or at the outside of a bend. Collect dew with a cloth. Rainwater is best when collected before it touches the ground.
- **Purify:** Boil, use unscented bleach (8 drops per gallon of clear water, 16 if cloudy, wait 30 minutes), or use a certified filter or tablets. See Water Treatment Instructions and Activated Charcoal in Part 2.
- **Store and rotate:** Keep treated water in clean, sealed, labeled containers.
- **Conserve:** Drink water first. Avoid strenuous work in heat. Eat foods with water in them, such as soup and cooked vegetables.

3. Shelter Learn now (basics) Intermediate (full builds)

- **Priorities:** Protection from wind, rain, and cold first. Keep off the ground, since heat leaves the body fastest there.
- **Tarp lean-to:** Tie a ridge line between two anchors, drape the tarp over it, and stake the sides. Angle the open side away from the wind.
- **Insulation:** Use a sleeping pad, or pile dry leaves, pine boughs, or a pack under a blanket.
- **Site choice:** Avoid dead trees, flood plains, ridgelines, and places where rocks can fall.

4. First aid and medical response Learn now (certified training recommended)

- **Bleeding (Stop the Bleed):** Apply firm direct pressure for several minutes. If bleeding continues, pack the wound with gauze and keep pressing. For a limb wound that won't stop, apply a tourniquet 2 to 3 inches above the wound, tighten until bleeding stops, and write down the time.
- **Burns:** Cool with cool running water for 10 to 20 minutes. Cover loosely with a clean, non-stick dressing. Do not use ice, butter, or ointment on large burns.
- **Fractures:** Immobilize the joint above and below the injury with splints. Check circulation (color, warmth, feeling) beyond the splint.
- **Hypothermia:** Get out of the wind and wet clothing. Insulate from the ground up. If the person is alert, give warm sweet drinks. Handle gently and avoid rubbing limbs.
- **Heat exhaustion and heatstroke:** Move to shade, cool the body, and give fluids if alert. Heatstroke (confusion, very high temperature, no sweating) is an emergency.
- **Choking:** Use back blows and abdominal thrusts for an adult.
- **CPR:** Push hard and fast at 100 to 120 compressions per minute, at least 2 inches deep, with 30 compressions to 2 breaths.
- **When professional help is available,** call emergency services early.
- **More:** First aid kit essentials and carbon monoxide safety are in the Safety Reference in Part 7.

5. Knots Learn now

- **Bowline:** A fixed loop that won't slip under load.
- **Clove hitch:** Quick attachment to a post or pole.
- **Taut-line hitch:** An adjustable loop for tent lines.
- **Trucker's hitch:** Gives mechanical advantage for tightening a load.

6. Signaling Learn now

- **Three signals:** Three whistle blasts, three fires, or three flashes is the widely recognized distress signal.
- **Mirror:** A signal mirror can be seen for miles in daylight. Aim with your hand or a V-shaped sight.
- **Visibility:** Bright clothing, a high location, and a clear area in an open space.
- **Radio:** Learn basic radio procedure (short messages, clear identification, a repeat-back to confirm).
- **Morse code:** A light or a whistle can carry a message. The alphabet and timing are in Morse Code in Part 4.

7. Food: preservation, cooking, and foraging

Learn now (preservation and cooking) Intermediate (foraging and trapping)

- **Preservation:** Drying (dehydrator, sun, or low oven), salting, and fermenting (sauerkraut, pickles). Dried meat needs thorough drying and should be eaten quickly.
- **Cooking over fire:** Use a grate, a pot on coals, or a Dutch oven. Coals give steady, even heat.
- **Foraging:** Only eat plants you have identified with certainty. Learn local edibles with an expert, and carry a field guide. Avoid mushrooms unless an expert has confirmed the species. When in doubt, leave it out.
- **Trapping and fishing:** Check local regulations before setting traps or fishing without a license, especially on private land and in protected areas. See Part 5.
- **More:** Long-term meat storage is in Part 2. Hunting, trapping, and fishing are in Part 5, and recipes are in Part 6.

8. Sanitation and hygiene Learn now

- **Hand washing:** Use soap and water for 20 seconds, especially after the toilet and before food. Use hand sanitizer only when water is unavailable.
- **Field latrine (if no toilet):** Dig a cat hole 6 to 8 inches deep, at least 200 feet from water, camp, and trails. Cover it when done.
- **Trash:** Keep waste sealed, and burn or bury it away from water and camp where legal.
- **Dishes:** Scrub with hot water and soap, rinse with treated water, and let them air dry.

9. Tools, repairs, and maintenance Learn now

- **Knife care:** Keep a sharpening stone or file. Sharpen at a consistent angle (about 20 degrees for most kitchen and utility knives). A dull knife is more dangerous than a sharp one.
- **Sewing kit:** Needles, thread, patches, safety pins, and a repair kit for boots and packs.
- **Repair basics:** Duct tape, cord, zip ties, and a multitool for fast fixes.

10. Security and awareness Learn now

- **Routines:** Keep consistent patterns, but vary the times you leave and come home.
- **Lighting and locks:** Motion lights at entries, solid door locks, and a secured spare key outside the home.
- **Information:** Share only what is needed. Keep valuables out of sight.
- **Self-defense:** Basic awareness, de-escalation, and a plan to leave are safer than confrontation. Take a self-defense course if you choose to be prepared physically.

11. Planning, routines, and morale Learn now

- **Rationing:** Plan meals and water use for the full duration. Track what you have each week.
- **Routines:** Set wake times, meals, chores, and rest. Routines reduce stress and keep people working together.
- **Rest and morale:** Sleep matters more than almost anything. Keep a calendar, play games, and check in with each other daily.
- **Shared decisions:** Agree on roles and who makes the call when you disagree.

Part 4: Communication and Navigation

Signals, maps, and a grid code that all work with no power.

Morse Code

Morse code works with a flashlight, a mirror, a whistle, a car horn, tapping on a pipe, or a radio key. It travels farther than a voice and needs no power beyond a light or a sound. Say a dot as "dit" and a dash as "dah".

Letter	Code	Letter	Code	Letter	Code
A	.-	**J**	.---	**S**	...
B	-...	**K**	-.-	**T**	-
C	-.-.	**L**	.-..	**U**	..-
D	-..	**M**	--	**V**	...-
E	.	**N**	-.	**W**	.--
F	..-.	**O**	---	**X**	-..-
G	--.	**P**	.--.	**Y**	-.--
H	....	**Q**	--.-	**Z**	--..
I	..	**R**	.-.		

Numbers									
1	.----	**2**	..---	**3**	...--	**4**	....-	**5**	.....
6	-....	**7**	--...	**8**	---..	**9**	----.	**0**	-----

Timing and key signals

- **Timing:** A dash lasts 3 dots. Leave 1 dot of silence between parts of a letter, 3 between letters, and 7 between words.
- **SOS:** ...---... sent as one run with no gaps between the letters. Repeat it, then pause and watch for a reply.
- **Over:** -.- (K) means "go ahead." .-.-. (AR) means end of message. ...-.- (SK) means end of contact.
- **Light signaling:** Aim a flashlight or signal mirror at the receiver. Short flash is a dot, long flash is a dash. Use the same timing as above.
- **Learn it:** Memorize by sound, not by looking at the chart. Learn E, T, I, A, N, M first, then add letters in small groups. Practice 10 minutes a day with your partner.

Map Reading and Navigation

A paper map and a compass need no batteries and cannot be jammed or damaged by a power surge. Learn them first. Treat a GPS as a bonus that may stop working.

Reading a topographic map

- **Check the legend, scale, and date:** Every map has a legend that explains its symbols and a scale that turns map distance into ground distance. Note the year, because roads, trails, and streams change.
- **North is usually at the top:** Read the margin for the declination diagram, which shows grid north, true north, and magnetic north.

Map color	What it shows
Blue	Water: lakes, streams, springs, swamps
Green	Woods and thick vegetation
White	Open ground, fields, and clearings
Brown	Contour lines (elevation) and landforms
Black	Buildings, trails, boundaries, and labels
Red	Major roads and other built features

Reading contour lines

- **Each line joins points at the same elevation.** The contour interval (for example 40 feet) is printed in the margin. Every fifth line is thicker and carries a number.
- **Close together means steep. Far apart means gentle.** Lines that touch or merge show a cliff.
- **Hills:** Closed rings, with the smallest ring on top. **Ridges:** Lines bulge away from the high ground. **Valleys and streams:** Lines form V shapes that point uphill, toward the source of the water.
- **Saddles:** The low point between two high points. **Depressions:** Closed rings with small tick marks pointing inward.

Reading latitude and longitude

- **Latitude** lines run east to west and measure distance north or south of the equator, from 0 to 90 degrees. **Longitude** lines run north to south and measure distance east or west of the prime meridian, from 0 to 180 degrees.
- **Say latitude first, then longitude.** In decimal degrees, south and west are negative numbers.
- **One degree of latitude is about 69 miles (111 km).** Degrees of longitude get shorter toward the poles.

Format	Example	Notes
Decimal degrees	38.8978° N, 77.0364° W	The easiest to write and encode
Degrees and decimal minutes	38° 53.868' N, 77° 02.184' W	Common on marine and aviation charts
Degrees, minutes, seconds	38° 53' 52" N, 77° 02' 11" W	Common on printed maps

Convert: decimal degrees = degrees + (minutes ÷ 60) + (seconds ÷ 3600). For 38° 53' 52": 38 + 0.8833 + 0.0144 = 38.8978.

Decimal places	Precision on the ground
1 (38.9)	About 11 km (7 miles)
2 (38.90)	About 1.1 km (0.7 mile)
3 (38.898)	About 110 m (360 feet)
4 (38.8978)	About 11 m (36 feet)
5 (38.89780)	About 1.1 m (3.6 feet)

Reading a UTM or MGRS grid

UTM (Universal Transverse Mercator) divides the world into square grids measured in meters. The numbers are easier to work with than degrees because distance is just subtraction.

- **Zones and bands:** There are 60 north-south zones, each 6 degrees wide, numbered from 1 to 60 going east from the 180-degree meridian. Latitude bands are lettered from C to X (without I and O). Together they form the grid zone, such as 18T.
- **Easting** is the distance east, in meters. It is 6 digits. A point on the zone's center line has an easting of 500,000.
- **Northing** is the distance north of the equator, in meters. It is 7 digits in the Northern Hemisphere.
- **Read right, then up.** Give the easting first (read across the bottom or top), then the northing (read up the side).
- **Grid lines are usually 1 km apart.** The map prints the full numbers at the edges and a short form (two or three digits, often in large type) along each line.
- **MGRS** (Military Grid Reference System) is the same grid in a shorter form: zone, band, two letters for the 100 km square, then the digits. Example: 18T WL 38214 45190.

Digits (east + north)	Example	Precision (square size)
2 + 2 (4 digits)	18T WL 38 45	1 km
3 + 3 (6 digits)	18T WL 382 451	100 m
4 + 4 (8 digits)	18T WL 3821 4519	10 m
5 + 5 (10 digits)	18T WL 38214 45190	1 m

Reading a point to 100 meters

1. Find the grid square that holds your point. Read the label of the line on its left edge (easting) and the label of the line on its bottom edge (northing).
2. Estimate how many tenths across the square the point sits from the left edge. A grid ruler (romer) makes this easy. Say it is 2 tenths.
3. Estimate how many tenths up from the bottom edge. Say it is 5 tenths.
4. If the left line is 538 (538,000 m) and the bottom line is 4345 (4,345,000 m), the 100 m reading is easting 3 8 2 and northing 4 5 5, written **382 455**.

Match your datum: Set the GPS format to UTM or MGRS and the datum to match the map (WGS 84 or NAD 83 for modern maps, NAD 27 for old ones). A mismatch can shift a position by several hundred feet.

Using a compass

A baseplate compass (the clear plastic kind with a rotating dial) is the best choice for map work. Learn its parts, then practice before you need it.

Part	What it does
Baseplate	The clear base. Its straight edges and ruler scales are used to draw lines and measure on a map.
Direction-of-travel arrow	Points where you want to go.
Rotating housing (dial)	Marked in degrees from 0 to 360. Turn it to set a bearing.
Orienting arrow and lines	The arrow and parallel lines inside the dial. They line up with north.
Magnetic needle	The red end points to magnetic north.
Index line	The mark where the dial meets the baseplate. Your bearing is read here.

Direction	Degrees	Direction	Degrees
North (N)	0 or 360	South (S)	180
Northeast (NE)	45	Southwest (SW)	225
East (E)	90	West (W)	270
Southeast (SE)	135	Northwest (NW)	315

Take a bearing in the field

1. Hold the compass flat and level in front of you, at about waist height, with the direction-of-travel arrow pointing at the object you chose.
2. Turn the housing until the orienting arrow sits under the red end of the needle ("red in the shed").
3. Read the number at the index line. That is the bearing to the object.
4. To walk that bearing, keep the needle in the shed and follow the arrow. Pick a landmark on the line and walk to it.
5. To go back, add 180 degrees to the bearing if it is under 180, or subtract 180 if it is over. That is the back bearing.

Go around an obstacle

1. Turn 90 degrees to the right (add 90 to your bearing) and count your paces until you are clear of the obstacle.
2. Turn back to your original bearing and walk until you are past the obstacle.
3. Turn 90 degrees to the left (subtract 90 from your bearing) and walk the same number of paces you counted in step 1.
4. Turn back to your original bearing. You are on your original line.

- **Keep it away from metal and electronics:** Phones, knives, belt buckles, and radios can throw off the needle at close range. Vehicles, power lines, and rebar can do it from 30 feet or more.
- **Hold it level:** A tilted compass can make the needle stick. Wait for it to settle.
- **Check it:** The red end should point the same way as a trusted compass. Keep a spare, and replace one that has bubbles or sticks.
- **In an emergency, no map:** Pick a bearing and stick to it. A steady line leads to a road, stream, or ridge, which you can follow out.

Using a compass with a map

- **Know your declination:** Magnetic north and true north differ by an angle that varies by place and changes slowly over time. In the United States it is roughly 20 degrees east in the Pacific Northwest and 15 or more degrees west in northern New England. Use the value on your map and update it from a current source.
- **Adjustable compass:** Set the declination once on the compass, then ignore it.
- **Fixed compass:** Going from map to compass, subtract east declination and add west declination. Going from compass to map, do the opposite. East is least, west is best.

Take a bearing from the map and follow it

1. Lay the long edge of the compass on the line from where you are to where you want to go, with the direction-of-travel arrow pointing toward the destination.
2. Turn the compass housing until the orienting lines are parallel to the map's north-south grid lines, with the orienting arrow pointing to the top of the map.
3. Read the bearing at the index line. Correct for declination.
4. Lift the compass off the map. Hold it level and turn your whole body until the red end of the needle sits inside the orienting arrow.
5. Pick a landmark on that line, such as a tree or rock, walk to it, and repeat. Do not stare at the compass while you walk.

Find your position (resection)

1. Pick two or three landmarks you can see and find on the map. Choose ones that are 60 to 120 degrees apart.
2. Point the compass at each one and read the bearing. Correct each for declination (compass to map).
3. Work out the back bearing, which points from the landmark to you. Add 180 degrees if the bearing is under 180, or subtract 180 degrees if it is over.
4. On the map, put the compass edge on the landmark, turn the housing to the back bearing, then pivot the compass until the orienting lines match the grid lines. Draw a line toward you.
5. Repeat for the other landmarks. Your position is where the lines cross. With three lines, the small triangle shows your error.

Navigation without a compass

- **Sun:** In the Northern Hemisphere the sun rises roughly in the east, sets roughly in the west, and is due south at midday.
- **Shadow stick:** Push a straight stick upright into level ground and mark the tip of its shadow. Wait 15 minutes and mark it again. A line through the two marks runs west to east, with the first mark on the west side.
- **Analog watch:** Point the hour hand at the sun. South is halfway between the hour hand and 12 o'clock (use 1 o'clock during daylight saving time).
- **Night:** Find the North Star by following the two end stars of the Big Dipper's cup. They point to it. It sits almost directly north.
- **Do not rely on moss** or tree growth. They are not reliable.

If you are lost

1. **Stop.** Sit down, drink water, and calm down. Panic causes bad decisions.
2. **Think.** Recall the last place you knew for certain. Check your map, compass, and the time.
3. **Observe.** Note landmarks, water, and daylight left. Stay put if you have shelter and water and others know your plan. Stay visible and make signals (see skill 6, Signaling).
4. **Plan.** If you must move, mark your route and move toward a known handrail, such as a road, trail, or large stream. Use a back bearing to return to where you started.

Distance, time, and route tips

- **Scale:** At 1:24,000, one inch is 2,000 feet and a 1 km grid square is about 1.6 inches. At 1:50,000, one centimeter is 500 m. At 1:100,000, one centimeter is 1 km.
- **Measure a winding route:** Lay a piece of string along it, straighten the string, and compare it to the scale bar.
- **Pace count:** Walk a measured 100 m on flat ground and count every time your left foot lands. Most people count between 55 and 70. Use your number to track distance when you cannot see landmarks. Add paces for hills, snow, and a heavy pack.
- **Time:** Allow 1 hour per 3 miles on level ground, plus 30 minutes for every 1,000 feet you climb.
- **Handrails:** Follow a stream, ridge, trail, or fence rather than crossing open ground.
- **Catching feature:** Pick a road, river, or ridge beyond your goal so you know you have gone too far.
- **Aim off:** When your goal is on a line (a road or stream), aim to one side on purpose. You will know which way to turn when you hit the line.

Prepare your maps now

- Keep topographic maps for your home area, your route to a rally point, and your retreat location. Cover at least 25 miles around each. County and state road maps are good backups.
- Put maps in zip bags or laminate them. Write the declination, the datum, and the date on each map.
- Mark water sources, rally points, and caches, using your coordinate code and not plain labels. Keep one marked copy at home and one in each vehicle.
- Keep a spare handheld GPS with fresh batteries in a closed metal can. This is a low-cost precaution, not a guarantee.
- Practice with a map and compass on a local trail. Take a bearing, follow it, and check your position with a landmark.

Coordinate Word Code (8-Digit Grid Reference)

Use this to send a location in a way casual listeners cannot use. You and your partner share one secret 10-letter keyword. Each letter stands for a digit, so a grid reference becomes a string of letters.

How to make your code

1. **Choose a keyword:** Pick a 10-letter word with no repeated letters. Memorize it. Do not write it in the guide or keep it with your coordinates.
2. **Number it:** Write the word out and put the numbers 1 to 9, then 0, under the letters. That is your code. Example for PATHFINDER:

P	A	T	H	F	I	N	D	E	R
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0

How to encode and decode

1. **Get an 8-digit reference:** 4 digits east and 4 digits north from your map or GPS. This is accurate to 10 meters (about 33 feet), which is enough to find a meeting spot or cache. Say the grid zone and 100 km square letters (for example 18T WL) once, in advance.
2. **Swap digits for letters:** Replace each digit with the letter above its number. Send east first, then north, in two groups of four.
3. **Decode in reverse:** Find each letter in the keyword and read the number under it.

Worked example (keyword PATHFINDER)

- **Grid reference:** East 3821, North 4519
- **Encode:** 3=T, 8=D, 2=A, 1=P and 4=H, 5=F, 1=P, 9=E
- **Send: TDAP HFPE**
- **Decode:** T=3, D=8, A=2, P=1 and H=4, F=5, P=1, E=9, which gives East 3821, North 4519.

Where the digits come from (UTM, MGRS, or latitude and longitude)

A full UTM reading has a zone and band (such as 18T), a 6-digit easting, and a 7-digit northing, all in meters. Only some of those digits go into the code.

1. **Start with the full reading:** for example 18T, 538214 E, 4345190 N.
2. **Drop the 100 km digits:** remove the first digit of the easting (5) and the first two digits of the northing (43). They name the 100 km square, which you and your partner agree on in advance.
3. **Keep four digits of each:** take the next four digits and cut off the rest. Always truncate, never round. Easting 538214 becomes 3821. Northing 4345190 becomes 4519.
4. **Encode:** 3821 4519 becomes **TDAP HFPE** with the keyword PATHFINDER.

Worked example with latitude and longitude

- **Agree in advance:** the whole degrees (for example 38 N and 77 W) and the hemisphere.
- **Reading:** 38.8978 N, 77.0364 W.
- **Keep the four digits after the decimal point:** 8978 and 0364 (about 10 meters).
- **Encode with PATHFINDER:** 8=D, 9=E, 7=N, 8=D and 0=R, 3=T, 6=I, 4=H.
- **Send: DEND RTIH**

Example keywords (each is 10 letters with no repeats)

- PATHFINDER
- BLACKSMITH
- DOWNSTREAM
- FIREPLANTS

Rules: Change the keyword on a schedule, such as monthly, and agree on 2 or 3 backup keywords in advance. Pre-agree 3 rendezvous points and name them by code word, not by location. Record them in the Family Contact Plan below, in code. This hides a location from casual listeners but will not stop someone who is trying to break it. Always confirm by a second method when you can.

Family Contact Plan (Paper Copy)

Fill this in by hand. Keep a copy at home, in each vehicle, and in your go-bags. Write meeting places as 8-digit grid references in your word code (see Coordinate Word Code above), and never write the keyword on this page.

- ☐ Out-of-area contact:
- ☐ Meeting place near home:
- ☐ Meeting place outside neighborhood:
- ☐ Fallback meeting places 1, 2, and 3 (in code):
- ☐ Doctor, pharmacy, and insurance:
- ☐ Neighbors with skills or equipment:

Skill Practice Checklist

Check each item off with your partner. This list covers the skills in Parts 3 and 4.

- ☐ Start a fire with a ferro rod, and with a match or lighter, in under 5 minutes.
- ☐ Treat a gallon of water with bleach and with your filter, and test the results.
- ☐ Build a tarp lean-to in under 30 minutes.
- ☐ Use a map and compass to follow a 1-mile route.
- ☐ Apply a bandage and direct pressure to a simulated bleeding wound.
- ☐ Tie a bowline, a clove hitch, a taut-line hitch, and a trucker's hitch.
- ☐ Cook a complete meal on your camp stove outdoors.
- ☐ Send and decode your name and SOS in Morse code with a flashlight, and with a partner across the yard.
- ☐ Encode and decode an 8-digit grid reference with your keyword, then check each other's answers. Memorize the keyword.
- ☐ Convert a latitude and longitude from degrees, minutes, and seconds to decimal degrees.
- ☐ Read a UTM or MGRS reference to 100 m on a topographic map, and plot a given reference.
- ☐ Take a field bearing to three landmarks, write them down, and work out each back bearing.
- ☐ Walk around an obstacle with the 90-degree method and land on your original line.
- ☐ Take a bearing from the map, correct for declination, and walk it for 500 m to a landmark.
- ☐ Find your position by resection using two landmarks, and check it against a trail or road.
- ☐ Count your pace over 100 m and use it to measure a short route.
- ☐ Mark your water sources and rally points on a paper map, in code.
- ☐ Make charcoal in a metal can, build a charcoal water filter, then boil the water it produces.
- ☐ Complete a 24-hour power-off drill.

Part 5: Hunting, Trapping, and Fishing

Getting, cleaning, butchering, and safely handling wild food.

Before anything else:

- **Check the law.** Hunting, trapping, and fishing are regulated by your state or province. You need the right license, tags, season, bag limits, and method rules. Many snare and trap rules differ by county. Look up your wildlife agency's current rules every season.
- **Take a hunter safety course** and practice firearm or bow safety until it's automatic. Never point a firearm at anything you don't intend to shoot.
- **Only hunt what you can identify and only take a clean, ethical shot.** If you aren't sure, don't shoot.

Hunting, Gutting, Skinning, and Quartering

Before the hunt

- Buy your license and any tags before the season opens. Know the bag limit and the legal shooting hours.
- Practice at a known distance until your shot group is consistent.
- Pack a field kit: sharp fixed-blade knife, a second blade, rope or paracord, game bags (breathable cloth), disposable nitrile gloves, paper towels, water, a headlamp, a small first aid kit, a tarp, and a way to mark your location (GPS or a map and compass).
- Tell someone where you're going and when you'll be back.

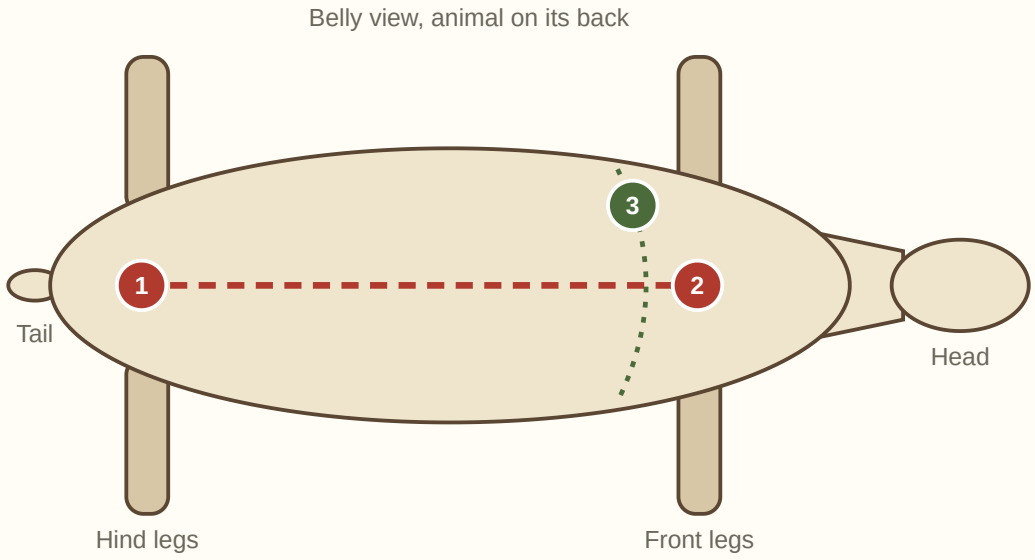
Ethical shot and tracking

- Aim for the vital zone behind the front shoulder. Shots to the spine or head are not a substitute for vital hits.
- After the shot, note where the animal was standing and wait before you follow. Many agencies recommend waiting 30 minutes for deer, longer in hot weather.
- Look for blood color and trail. Bright red frothy blood often means a lung hit. Dark blood often means a liver hit. Follow the trail slowly and carefully.
- If you can't find the animal after a reasonable search, stop and report it as your agency directs. Don't hunt past dark on an unclear track.

Field dressing (gutting) large game

Field dressing removes the internal organs quickly so the meat cools. Work with gloves on. Keep the knife blade pointed away from the organs.

1. **Position the animal** on its back, on a slope if possible, with the head downhill.
2. **Make a shallow cut** through the skin and belly muscle from just in front of the pelvis to the breastbone (Figure 1). Pinch the skin and lift it away from the organs. Slide two fingers under the wall and guide the blade between them.
3. **Cut around the anus** (for males) or leave it in place with a circle cut (for females). Tie off the rectum with a knot or plastic bag if you need to keep the carcass clean.
4. **Open the chest.** Cut the thin diaphragm membrane that separates the chest from the belly, which is easiest with the hand inside the cavity. Reach up and cut the windpipe and the esophagus at the top, as high as you can reach.
5. **Pull the organs out** in one motion, rolling the intestines and stomach out of the cavity. Keep the heart and liver if you plan to eat them. Discard the bladder and any spilled stomach contents.
6. **Wipe the cavity** with paper towels. Rinse with clean water only if the water is clean. Do not soak the meat.
7. **Prop the cavity open** with a stick so air can circulate, and get the animal cooled.



1. Start just in front of the pelvis, between the hind legs. Cut through hide and belly muscle only.
2. Follow the midline to the end of the breastbone. Keep the blade edge up, guided between two fingers so it never touches the organs.
3. Cut the diaphragm (the thin wall behind the ribs) all the way around, then reach forward and cut the windpipe.

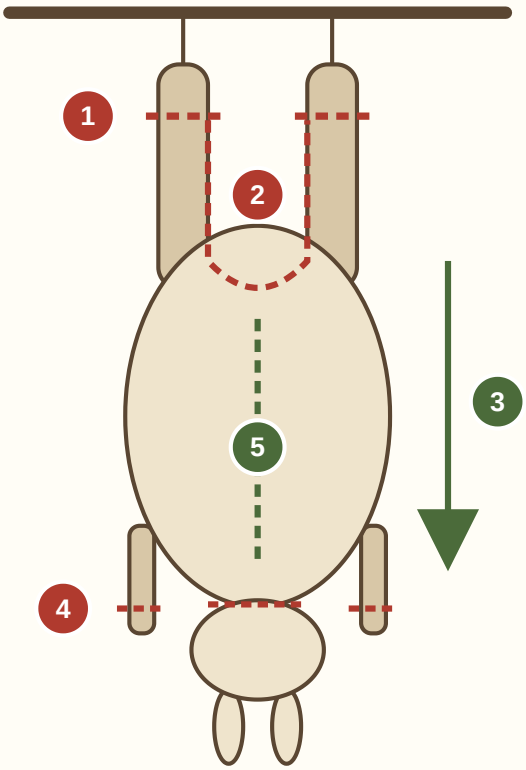
Figure 1. Field-dressing cuts, viewed from the belly with the animal on its back.

Skinning large game

- **Hang the animal** by the hind legs from a gambrel or sturdy branch. This is the easiest way to skin.
- **Cut the hide around each hind leg** and along the inside of the rear legs toward the belly.
- **Work the hide down** with the knife held flat against the skin, pulling it away from the meat. Use your fist to separate the hide and meat where they stick.
- **Remove the front legs** at the knee or shoulder, then the head at the top of the neck if you're keeping the hide.
- **Keep the hide clean.** Keep dirt and hair off the meat as you go.

Skinning small game (rabbit and squirrel)

Rabbits and squirrels can carry tularemia. Wear disposable gloves for every step and wash your hands and tools afterward.

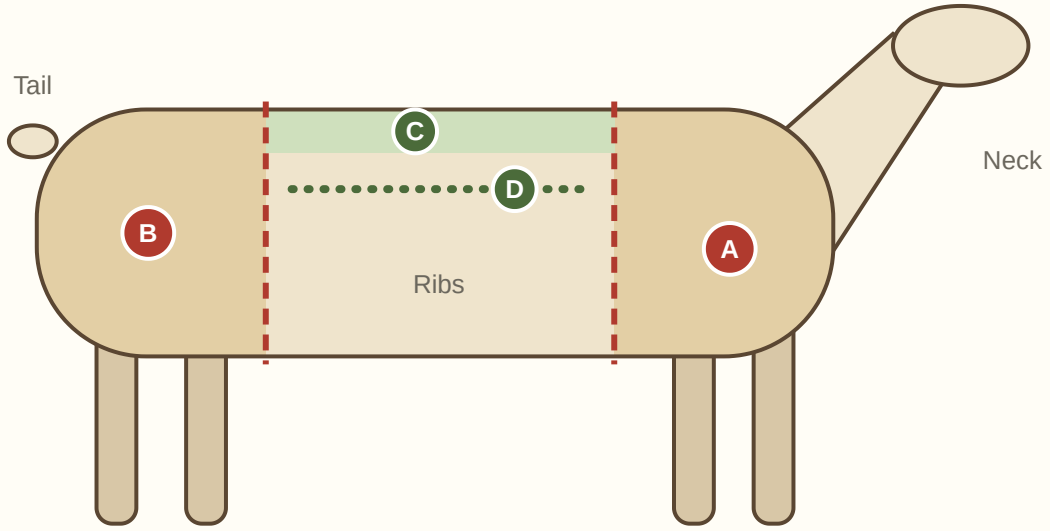


1. Hang the rabbit by its hind legs. Cut through the skin all the way around each hind leg, just above the foot.
2. Cut down the inside of each hind leg to the base of the tail, joining the two cuts.
3. Pull the skin down over the body like a sock, working it loose with your fingers.
4. Cut off the front feet and the head where the skin ends.
5. Open the belly along the midline, remove the organs, rinse in clean water, and chill.

Figure 2. Skinning a rabbit hung by its hind legs. Squirrels follow the same order, but their skin is tougher and takes more pulling.

Quartering large game

Quartering splits the carcass into manageable pieces for transport and cooling. Once the animal is skinned, use the joints as guides instead of sawing bone.



- **A** Front shoulder: no joint holds it on. Lift the leg and cut flat along the rib cage, under the shoulder blade.
- **B** Hind leg (ham): cut around the hip joint and separate the ball from the socket.
- **C** Backstrap: the long loin along the top of the spine. Lift it off whole.
- **D** Tenderloin: a small muscle inside the body cavity, under the spine. Remove it whole.
- **–** Ribs and neck: trim for stew or grinding.

Figure 3. Quartering map of a deer (side view, head on the right). Shaded areas are the quarters and the backstrap.

1. **Remove the front shoulders (A).** The shoulder isn't attached by a joint. Pull the leg away from the body and cut flat along the rib cage, under the shoulder blade, until it comes free.
2. **Remove the hind legs (B).** Cut around the hip joint and separate the ball from its socket. The hind leg is the largest piece, the ham.
3. **Remove the backstraps (C) and tenderloins (D).** These are the long muscles on either side of the spine. Slice along the backbone to lift them off whole. These are the most tender cuts.
4. **Trim the ribs and neck** into stew or grinding meat.
5. **Bag each piece** in a game bag or cloth and get it cooling. Label the bags.

Cooling and transport

- Get the carcass cooled within a few hours. In cold weather, hang it in shade. In warm weather, put the quarters on ice or in cold running water.
- Keep meat below 40°F. Don't stack pieces together or pack them in plastic bags while they're warm.

- Protect the meat from flies, dirt, and direct sun while you transport it.

Taking the Meat Off Each Animal

Once an animal is gutted and skinned, the next step is removing the usable meat. Work on a clean surface with a sharp boning knife, a cutting board you use only for game, and cold hands and tools. Keep the meat below 40°F while you cut. Cut pieces can go into a cooler or cold water as you finish each one.

> **Trim as you go:** Remove silver skin (the thin, shiny membrane), bloody spots, and connective tissue. Remove fat too, since it carries a strong gamey taste and spoils faster. Meat you trim can be ground or used for stew.

Large game (deer, elk, and similar)

Start from the quarters you cut in the quartering section above. Each piece comes off as a roast, steak, or grinding meat.

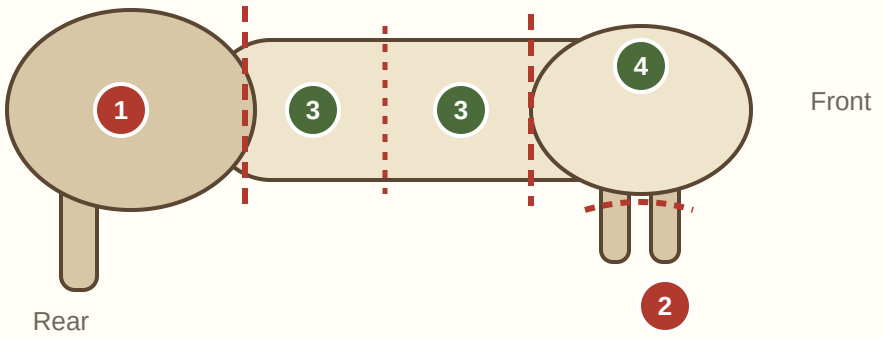
1. **Front shoulder:** Cut along the shoulder blade and separate it from the leg at the joint. Use it for a shoulder roast, braise it whole, or grind it. Shoulder is tougher, so slow-cook or grind it.
2. **Hind leg (ham):** Cut around the ball joint to separate the leg from the hip. Work along the seams between muscles, and separate each muscle group. The inside round and outside round make roasts. The bottom round and shank make stew or grind meat. The top round and sirloin can be sliced into steaks.
3. **Backstrap (loin):** The long muscle along the spine. Lift it off whole and cut into steaks or a roast. It's the most tender cut.
4. **Tenderloin:** A small, tender muscle hidden inside along the spine, under the backbone. Remove it whole. Cut into medallions or leave whole for a roast.
5. **Ribs:** Trim the rib meat from the bones. Use the meat for stew, grinding, or slow-cooked ribs.
6. **Neck:** Tough but flavorful. Braise it, or grind it for sausage or burger.
7. **Trim and grind:** Collect all trimmed meat, chill it until it's firm, and grind or chop it by hand. Keep ground meat in small packages and freeze or preserve it quickly.

Rabbit

A rabbit yields about 1 to 1.5 lb of meat. It's small enough that you can cut it into four or five pieces.

1. **Hind legs (1):** Bend the leg back to find the hip joint and cut through it. Each hind leg is a meaty piece for roasting, frying, or stew.
2. **Front legs (2):** They aren't attached by a joint. Lift each leg and slice along the rib cage, under the shoulder blade. They're small, so use them for stew or frying.
3. **Saddle (3):** The back section between the legs. Cut it in two at the midpoint for two loin pieces. Keep the loin meat on the bone for stew or roast it whole.

4. **Rib cage and belly (4):** Cut the rib section off the saddle just behind the ribs. There's little meat on it, so use it with the thin belly flaps for stew or broth.



1. Hind legs: bend each leg back to find the hip joint, and cut through it.
2. Front legs: no joint attaches them. Slice along the rib cage, under the shoulder blade.
3. Saddle (loin): cut in two. It's the meatiest part after the hind legs.
4. Rib cage and belly flaps: little meat. Use for stew or broth.

Figure 4. Cutting up a skinned, gutted rabbit (side view, rear on the left).

Squirrel

A squirrel yields a small amount of meat, so plan on one per person or more for a meal. Cut it into four pieces the same way as a rabbit: hind legs, front legs, and the saddle in two pieces. Use the meat for stew, frying, or grinding. Cook squirrel thoroughly to 160°F.

Game birds (duck, grouse, pheasant)

1. **Pluck or skin:** Plucking gives better meat for roasting. Skinning is faster and removes most of the fat, but the meat dries out more quickly. For either method, work from the breast toward the legs and wings.
2. **Remove the breasts:** Lay the bird on its back. Cut down along the keel bone (the breastbone ridge) and lift each breast off in one piece by following the rib cage with the knife.
3. **Remove the legs:** Bend the leg back to find the hip joint. Cut through the skin and the joint, then pull the leg free.
4. **Remove the wings:** Cut through the shoulder joint and remove them whole, or use them for broth.
5. **Clean the cavity:** Remove the entrails, crop (the pouch at the base of the neck), and any remaining organs. Rinse with clean water only if it's clean.

Fish

- **Fillets:** Use the fillet method in the fish-cleaning section below (Figure 7).
- **Steaks:** For larger fish, cut crosswise into steaks about 1 inch thick, behind the pectoral fin. Leave the bone in for flavor.

- **Skinning a fillet:** Lay the fillet skin side down. Hold the tail end and cut between the flesh and the skin, angling the blade slightly down and keeping it flat against the skin.

Trapping

> **Trapping laws are strict and vary widely.** Many places require a trapping license, trap tags, and specific trap types. Many also require you to check traps at set intervals (often every 24 hours). Some places ban snares entirely. Confirm the rules for your location before setting anything.

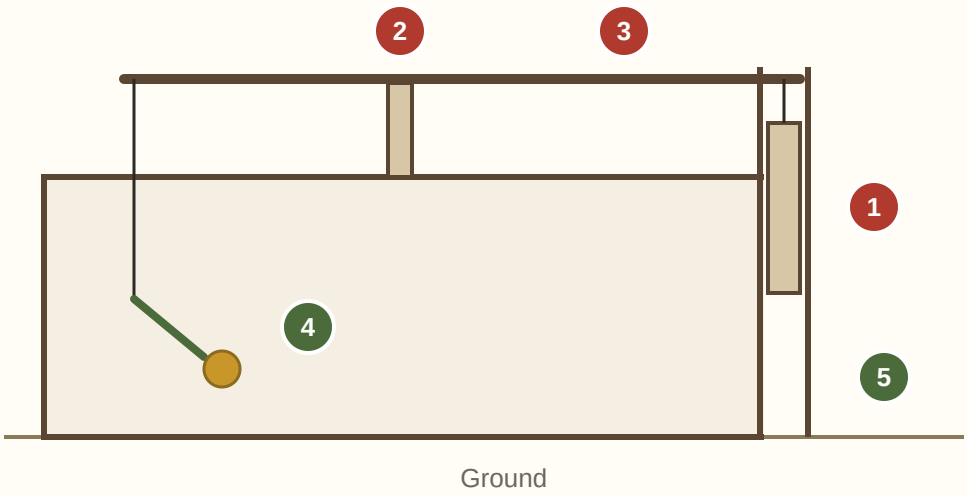
Common trap types for small game

Trap	Used for	Notes
Box or cage trap (live)	Rabbits, squirrels, and other small mammals	Easy to learn. Lets you release non-target animals alive. Bait with apple, carrot, or oats.
Snare (wire or cable loop)	Rabbits and similar animals using trails	Check local law first. Use a locking loop and set it so the animal isn't left to suffer. Check often.
Deadfall	Small game	Requires building skills and planning. Dangerous to people and pets if set carelessly.
Funnel trap (fish)	Minnows and small fish	Useful for bait fish. Check license rules for fish traps.

How to make each trap

The table above lists the main types. This section explains how each is built. Check your local laws before you build or set any of them. Many places restrict snares, deadfalls, and trap types, and some require specific tags or check intervals.

1. Box or cage trap (live trap for rabbits and squirrels)



1. Door: slides up and down between two guides, and stays raised until the trap trips.
2. Pivot post on top of the box.
3. Lever: one end holds the door up with a short cord, and the other end connects to the trigger.
4. Trigger stick and bait at the back. When the animal tugs the bait, the lever releases and the door drops.
5. Open end: the animal enters here.

Figure 5. Box trap, side view. Size it about 12 by 12 by 24 inches for rabbits.

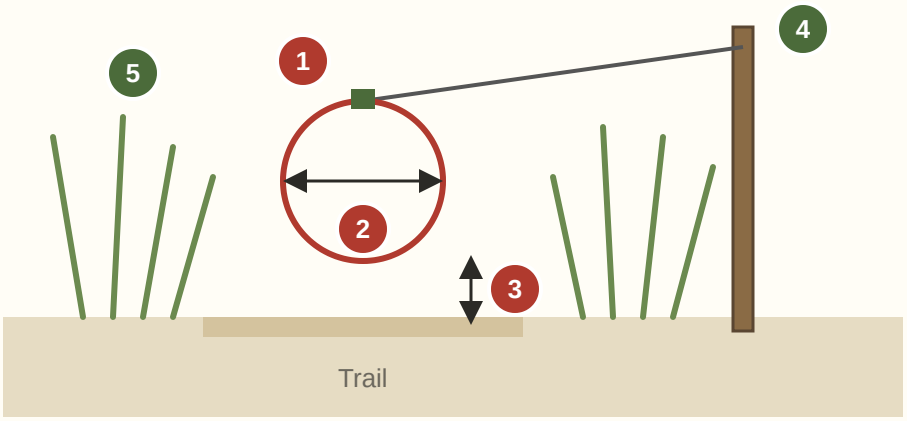
- **Frame:** Build a box about 12 x 12 x 24 inches for rabbits, using untreated wood or welded wire mesh with openings small enough that the animal can't reach through. Use wire mesh with 1-inch or smaller openings for small animals.
- **Door:** Make a door that slides in a groove or drops from above. It should close fast and stay closed.
- **Trigger:** Attach a trigger stick (a thin stick or wire) to a catch that holds the door open. Set the trigger so the animal must step past the bait to pull it. Place the bait at the back of the box.
- **Air and drainage:** Include ventilation on all sides, and a floor that drains. Animals die quickly in a closed box in heat.
- **Bait:** Apple slices, carrot, oats, or leafy greens. Replace bait every few days.
- **Check often:** Check at least every 24 hours, or more often in heat. Release non-targets right away.

2. Funnel or minnow trap (fish and bait fish)

- **Frame:** Use a cylinder of wire mesh about 12 inches long and 6 inches across, or a wooden frame covered with mesh.
- **Entrances:** Add a funnel at each end. The inner tip of each funnel should be narrow, so fish can enter but can't turn around easily.

- **Bait:** Crushed bread, cornmeal, or a bit of cut fish, in a mesh bag inside the trap.
- **Set:** Tie the trap to a line with a float or stake so you can find it. Check the regulations for minnow traps and fish funnels before you set one.

3. Wire snare (rabbits and similar animals using trails)



1. Locking loop: slides closed and won't loosen.
2. Loop about 3 to 4 inches across for rabbits, centered on the trail.
3. Bottom of the loop a few inches above the ground.
4. Anchor stake, driven in firmly. Tie the wire to it with a swivel.
5. Brush or sticks on each side to guide the animal into the loop.

Figure 6. Snare set, looking down the trail. Check local law first: snares are restricted or banned in many places.

- **Materials:** Use braided snare wire or aircraft cable. Make a locking loop: a sliding loop that tightens but doesn't loosen once set.
- **Anchor:** Attach the wire to a sturdy stake or a flexible sapling. Use a swivel so the wire doesn't twist.
- **Loop size:** Make the loop about 3 to 4 inches across for rabbits, centered over the trail and a few inches off the ground.
- **Set:** Place the snare where animals regularly pass, such as narrow gaps under brush or through a fence. Use cover to funnel animals into the loop.
- **Check often:** Check at least every 24 hours. A snare that catches a non-target animal should be checked immediately, and the non-target released if it's unharmed.

4. Deadfall (small game)

- **Principle:** A heavy weight (a rock or log) falls on the animal when it trips a trigger. A figure-four trigger is the classic design: a baited stick holds up the weight, and a second stick is tripped when the animal pulls the bait.
- **Build:** Use a flat log or rock as the weight, two uprights to guide it, and a trigger assembly held together with the figure-four notches. Keep the trigger light enough that a small animal can trip it.
- **Safety:** A deadfall can seriously injure a person, child, or pet. Never set one on a path, near camp, or where people or pets could walk. Many places ban deadfalls, so confirm before you build one.
- **Use only where legal and only with supervision.** It's the hardest trap to build and set safely, so start with a box trap.

5. Hoop or fyke net (fish)

- **Frame:** Use two or three wire or wooden hoops, each about 18 to 24 inches across, joined into a tube.
- **Mesh:** Cover the frame with netting, with funnels inside each hoop so fish can enter but can't leave.
- **Bait and set:** Bait the tail end and set in shallow water where fish swim. Mark the net with a float and check it regularly.
- **Check the rules:** Many waters restrict fish nets and traps, and some require a permit or specific mesh size.

Choosing a setting

- **Find animal sign:** droppings, tracks, chewed bark, and well-worn trails.
- **Set on the trail,** not in open ground. Animals use the same paths over and over.
- **Use cover** such as brush or logs to funnel animals toward the trap.
- **Keep traps away from pets, people, and paths** that people walk.
- **Mark each trap** with the tag your license requires.

Checking, handling, and releasing

- Check traps as often as the law requires, and early in the day if possible.
- Release non-target animals promptly and unharmed, or follow your agency's rules for them.
- Dispatch animals humanely and quickly, following your agency's guidance. Carry a club or other proper tool.
- Wear gloves for all handling. Rabbits and squirrels can carry tularemia.
- Process trapped animals the same way you'd process hunted game (above).

Fishing and Fish Cleaning

Before you fish

- Buy a fishing license for your location and learn the bag and size limits.
- Check whether your location allows nets, traps, or handlines. Some waters are catch-and-release only.

Simple gear and rigs

- **Handline:** 20 to 30 feet of strong line, a hook, a split shot sinker, and a bobber. Wrap the line around a stick or a plastic bottle.
- **Trotline:** A long main line across the water with many hooks on short drop lines. Check the regulations first, because many places restrict trotlines.
- **Bait:** Worms, grasshoppers, small crickets, minnows, and cut pieces of fish.
- **Improved clinch knot:** Pass the line through the hook eye, wrap it 5 to 7 times around the standing line, pass the tag end through the first loop above the eye and then through the big loop, moisten, and pull tight.

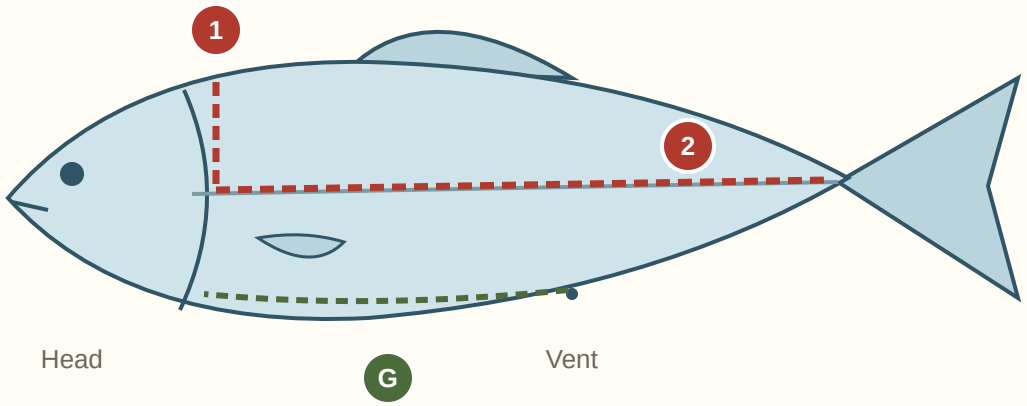
Where and when

- Fish early and late in the day, when many species feed.
- Look for structure: fallen trees, rock edges, weed beds, and deeper water near shore.

Killing and handling

- Handle fish with wet hands or wet gloves to protect their slime coat.
- Kill fish quickly and humanely according to your agency's guidance. Keep fish on a stringer or in a cooler in cool water until you clean them.

Cleaning a fish



- G — Gutting (for cooking whole): cut from the vent forward to the gills along the belly. Remove the guts and the dark kidney line along the backbone. Skip this step if you're filleting.
- 1 — Fillet: cut behind the gill plate, down to the backbone.
- 2 — Turn the blade flat and run it along the backbone to the tail. Lift the fillet off, flip the fish, and repeat.

Figure 7. Gutting and filleting a fish (head on the left).

1. **Scale the fish** by scraping from tail toward head with the back of the knife. Do this in a basin of water to keep scales contained.
2. **Gut the fish.** Cut from the vent toward the gills along the belly, then pull out the guts. Remove the dark kidney line along the backbone and rinse the cavity.
3. **Fillet (optional).** Follow Figure 7: cut behind the gill plate down to the backbone, then slide the knife along the spine to the tail. Lift the fillet away, flip, and repeat.
4. **Rinse and chill** the fish or fillets. Keep them cold and eat within 1 to 2 days, or preserve them.

Preserving fish

- **Cool:** Keep fish on ice or in cold water.
- **Dry or smoke:** Cut fillets into thin strips, salt them lightly, and dry them until firm. Fish preserved this way should be cooked before eating and kept cool.
- **Can:** Use a pressure canner and a tested recipe. Never use a water bath for fish.

Game Food Safety and Cooking Temperatures

- **Cook all game thoroughly.** Cook whole cuts and ground game to **160°F** measured with a thermometer in the thickest part. Cook fish to **145°F**.
- **Avoid cross-contamination.** Keep a separate cutting board and knife for game. Wash hands, boards, and tools with hot soapy water after each animal.
- **Avoid sick animals.** Don't eat any animal that looks sick, acts strangely, or has unusual lesions, tumors, or other signs of disease.

- **Chronic wasting disease (CWD):** In areas where CWD is present, follow your agency's guidance. This often includes testing your animal and avoiding brain and spinal tissue.
- **Tularemia:** Wear gloves when handling rabbits and squirrels, and cook them thoroughly.
- **Refrigerate without power:** A closed fridge keeps food cold for about 4 hours. Use cold packs, a cooler, or natural cold such as a cellar or shaded creek to keep meat below 40°F.
- **Home jerky:** USDA guidance recommends heating marinated meat strips to 160°F before drying. Dry until firm and leathery, and store in a cool, dry place.

Part 6: Recipes

Pantry recipes first, then wild game. All of them use the Part 2 grocery lists.

Emergency Cookbook (Pantry Recipes)

Recipes serve 2 unless noted. Cooking uses fuel and water, so reduce both where you can. Use canned beans when fuel or water is tight. Use the no-cook recipes when fuel runs out.

Breakfast

1. Oatmeal Breakfast Bowl Breakfast

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 cup rolled oats, 2 cups water (or 1 cup water plus 1 cup reconstituted powdered milk), pinch of salt, 2 tbsp dried fruit, 1 tbsp honey, 1 tbsp peanut butter.

1. Bring liquid and salt to a boil.
2. Stir in oats and dried fruit. Simmer 5 minutes, stirring often.
3. Top with honey and peanut butter.

2. Pancakes Breakfast

Serves 2 (about 6 pancakes)

Ingredients: 1 cup flour, 2 tsp baking powder, 1 tbsp sugar, 1/4 tsp salt, 1/3 cup powdered milk, 1 cup water, 1 tbsp oil.

1. Whisk flour, baking powder, sugar, salt, and powdered milk.
2. Add water and oil, and stir until just combined. Let the batter rest 5 minutes.
3. Oil a skillet on medium-low. Pour 1/4 cup batter per pancake. Flip when bubbles form and the edges look set.

Serve with honey, peanut butter, or canned fruit.

3. Rice Pudding Breakfast or dessert

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 cup rice, 1 cup water, pinch of salt, 1 cup reconstituted powdered milk (1/3 cup powder plus 1 cup water), 2 tbsp sugar, 1/2 tsp cinnamon, 1 tbsp honey (optional).

1. Simmer rice in water with salt for about 15 minutes, until the water is absorbed.
2. Add milk gradually and stir. Simmer 20 to 25 minutes on low, stirring often, until creamy.
3. Stir in sugar and cinnamon. Add honey if you have it.

Lunch and dinner

4. Rice and Bean Chili Main

Serves 2 (one pot)

Ingredients: 1/2 cup dry rice, 1 cup cooked beans (or 1 can, rinsed), 1 can (14.5 oz) diced tomatoes, 1/2 cup canned corn, 1 tbsp oil, 1 bouillon cube, 1 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp cumin, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp salt, 3 cups water.

1. Heat oil in a pot. Add spices for 30 seconds until fragrant.
2. Add water, bouillon, tomatoes, beans, and corn. Simmer 10 minutes.
3. Stir in rice. Cover and simmer on low for 20 minutes, adding water if it thickens too much. Rice is done when tender.

5. Chicken and Rice Skillet Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 cup cooked rice (leftover is fine), 1 can (5 oz) chicken, drained, 1/2 can mixed vegetables, 1 tbsp oil, 1 bouillon cube dissolved in 1/3 cup water, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, salt and pepper.

1. Heat oil in a skillet. Add garlic powder and vegetables for 2 minutes.
2. Add chicken, rice, and bouillon broth. Cook 5 minutes until hot and most liquid is absorbed.
3. Season to taste.

6. Skillet Flatbread Bread

Serves 2 (makes 4)

Ingredients: 2 cups all-purpose flour, 1 tsp baking powder, 1/2 tsp salt, about 3/4 cup water, 1 tbsp oil.

1. Mix flour, baking powder, and salt. Add oil and water a little at a time until a soft dough forms.
2. Divide into 4 balls and flatten to about 1/2 inch thick.
3. Oil a skillet and cook on medium-low with the lid on, 4 to 5 minutes per side, until golden.

Serve with peanut butter and honey, or with canned chicken or tuna.

7. One-Pot Chicken Pasta Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 cup dry pasta, 1 can (5 oz) chicken, 1/2 can mixed vegetables, 1 bouillon cube, 1 tbsp oil, 1 1/2 cups water, salt and pepper.

1. Bring water, bouillon, and oil to a boil.
2. Add pasta and vegetables. Simmer 10 to 12 minutes, stirring often, until the pasta is tender and most water is absorbed.
3. Stir in chicken and season.

8. Lentil and Rice Soup Soup

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 cup dry lentils (rinsed), 1/4 cup rice, 1 tbsp oil, 1 tsp onion powder, 1 bouillon cube, 1/2 can mixed vegetables or carrots, 1/2 tsp cumin, 1/2 tsp salt, 4 cups water.

1. Heat oil in a pot. Add onion powder and cumin for 30 seconds.
2. Add water, bouillon, lentils, and rice. Bring to a boil, then simmer 25 to 30 minutes, until lentils are soft.
3. Add vegetables and salt. Simmer 5 more minutes.

9. Tuna Noodle Skillet Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 cup pasta, 1 can (5 oz) tuna, drained, 1/2 cup corn, 1 tbsp flour, 1 tbsp oil, 1/2 cup reconstituted powdered milk (1/6 cup powder plus 1/2 cup water), 1 bouillon cube, pepper.

1. Cook pasta in 2 cups water until tender. Drain, reserving 1/3 cup of the cooking water.
2. In a skillet, heat oil and stir in flour for 30 seconds. Whisk in milk, reserved water, and bouillon. Simmer until thick, about 3 minutes.
3. Fold in pasta, tuna, and corn. Season with pepper.

10. Bean Burritos on Flatbread Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 cup cooked or canned beans, 1 tbsp oil, 1/2 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp cumin, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, salt, 2 flatbreads (recipe 6, halved), 1/2 cup cooked rice, 1/2 can chicken (optional).

1. Mash beans with oil and spices in a pan over medium heat for 5 minutes, adding a splash of water if dry.
2. Warm the flatbreads in a dry skillet.
3. Spread beans on each flatbread, top with rice and chicken if using, and roll.

11. TVP Taco Filling Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 cup dry textured vegetable protein, 3/4 cup hot bouillon broth (1 cube in 3/4 cup water), 1 tbsp oil, 1 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp cumin, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp salt.

1. Stir TVP into hot broth. Let stand 5 minutes until soft.
2. Heat oil in a skillet. Add spices for 30 seconds.
3. Add rehydrated TVP and cook 5 minutes, stirring, until it browns slightly.

Serve with rice, flatbread, or bean burritos.

12. Potato and Chicken Chowder Soup

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 cup potato flakes, 1 can (5 oz) chicken, drained, 1/2 cup corn, 1/2 cup reconstituted powdered milk (1/6 cup powder plus 1/2 cup water), 2 cups water, 1 bouillon cube, 1 tbsp oil, 1 tbsp flour, pepper.

1. Heat oil in a pot. Stir in flour for 30 seconds.
2. Whisk in water, bouillon, and milk. Bring to a simmer.
3. Stir in potato flakes, chicken, and corn. Simmer 3 to 5 minutes until thick. Season with pepper.

Desserts and snacks

13. Fruit Cobbler in a Pot Dessert

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 can (15 oz) canned fruit with juice, 1 cup flour, 2 tbsp sugar, 1 tsp baking powder, pinch of salt, 1/2 cup water, 1 tbsp oil, 1/4 tsp cinnamon (optional).

1. Pour fruit and juice into a pot. Simmer 5 minutes.
2. Mix flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Add oil and water to form a soft dough.
3. Drop spoonfuls over the fruit. Cover and cook on low for 15 to 20 minutes, until the topping is cooked through.

14. Peanut Butter Honey Energy Bars No-cook

Makes 8 bars

Ingredients: 1 cup rolled oats, 1/4 cup peanut butter, 2 tbsp honey, 2 tbsp dried fruit (chopped), 1 tbsp powdered milk, pinch of salt, pinch of cinnamon (optional).

1. Mix everything in a bowl until it holds together. Add a splash of water if too dry.
2. Press into a lined pan or shape into 8 bars.
3. Chill if you can. Store wrapped in a cool place for up to a week.

No-cook recipes (for when fuel is out)

15. Tuna and Bean Salad No-cook

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 can (15 oz) beans, drained and rinsed, 1 can (5 oz) tuna, drained, 1/2 cup corn, 1 tbsp oil, pinch of salt, pepper, 1 tsp honey (optional).

1. Combine beans, tuna, and corn in a bowl.
2. Stir in oil, honey, salt, and pepper.
3. Serve on its own or with flatbread.

16. Peanut Butter Honey Wraps No-cook

Serves 2

Ingredients: 2 flatbreads or cooked tortillas, 2 tbsp peanut butter, 1 tbsp honey, 2 tbsp dried fruit (chopped).

1. Spread peanut butter and honey on the flatbread, add dried fruit, roll, and eat.

Wild Game Recipes

These recipes use the 2-week and 90-day pantry items from the Part 2 grocery lists (rice, beans, flour, oats, pasta, lentils, potato flakes, dry TVP, canned vegetables, bouillon, oil, honey, peanut butter, dried fruit, powdered milk, and seasonings). Recipes serve 2 unless noted. Amounts are a starting point. Adjust for what you catch.

Breakfast

W1. Game Sausage Patties Breakfast

Serves 2 (about 6 patties)

Ingredients: 1/2 lb ground game (venison, rabbit, or squirrel), 1/4 cup rolled oats, 1/2 tsp salt, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp black pepper, 1/4 tsp cinnamon, 1 tbsp oil.

1. Grind or finely chop the meat. Mix with oats and seasonings. Shape into 6 small patties.
2. Heat oil in a skillet over medium heat. Cook patties 4 to 5 minutes per side until the center reaches 160°F.

W2. Peanut Butter Honey Oat Bars (with jerky, optional) No-cook

Makes 8 bars

Ingredients: 1 cup rolled oats, 1/4 cup peanut butter, 2 tbsp honey, 2 tbsp dried fruit (chopped), 1 tbsp powdered milk, 1/4 cup crushed dried jerky (optional), pinch of salt.

1. Mix everything. Add a splash of water if dry.
2. Press into a lined pan and chill, or shape into 8 bars.

Soups and stews

W3. Venison and Vegetable Stew Stew

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 lb venison or rabbit, cut into chunks, 1 tbsp oil, 1/2 cup potato flakes, 1 can (15 oz) mixed vegetables, 2 bouillon cubes, 1 tbsp flour, 1 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp black pepper, 4 cups water.

1. Brown meat in oil in a pot over medium-high heat, 5 minutes.
2. Add water, bouillon, and garlic powder. Simmer covered 45 to 60 minutes, until the meat is tender and reaches 160°F.
3. Add vegetables and simmer 5 minutes. Stir flour into 2 tbsp cold water, add to the pot, and simmer until thick.
4. Stir in potato flakes until it reaches your desired thickness. Season with pepper.

W4. Lentil and Game Soup Soup

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 cup dry lentils (rinsed), 1/2 lb venison or rabbit (cut small), 1 tbsp oil, 1 tsp onion powder, 1/2 tsp cumin, 1 bouillon cube, 1/2 can carrots or mixed vegetables, 1/2 tsp salt, 4 cups water.

1. Brown the meat in oil with onion powder and cumin, 5 minutes.
2. Add water, bouillon, and lentils. Bring to a boil, then simmer 30 minutes, until lentils are soft and meat reaches 160°F.
3. Add vegetables and salt. Simmer 5 more minutes.

W5. Fish Chowder Fish

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 lb fish fillets (cut into chunks), 1 cup potato flakes, 1/2 cup corn, 1/2 cup reconstituted powdered milk (1/6 cup powder plus 1/2 cup water), 2 cups water, 1 bouillon cube, 1 tbsp oil, 1 tbsp flour, pepper.

1. Heat oil in a pot, stir in flour for 30 seconds.
2. Whisk in water, bouillon, and milk. Bring to a simmer.
3. Add fish and corn. Simmer 5 minutes until fish reaches 145°F. Stir in potato flakes until thick. Season with pepper.

Main dishes

W6. Venison Rice Chili Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 lb ground venison, 1/2 cup dry rice, 1 cup cooked beans (or 1 can, rinsed), 1 can (14.5 oz) diced tomatoes, 1/2 cup corn, 1 tbsp oil, 1 bouillon cube, 1 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp cumin, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp salt, 3 cups water.

1. Brown the ground venison in oil with the spices, 5 minutes.
2. Add water, bouillon, tomatoes, beans, and corn. Simmer 10 minutes.
3. Stir in rice. Cover and simmer on low 20 minutes, adding water as needed, until rice is tender and meat reaches 160°F.

W7. Rabbit and Rice Pilaf Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 rabbit (about 1 lb meat, cut into pieces), 1 cup dry rice, 1 tbsp oil, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 2 bouillon cubes, 1/2 can carrots or mixed vegetables, 1/2 tsp salt, pepper, 2 1/2 cups water.

1. Brown the rabbit pieces in oil, 5 to 7 minutes. Add garlic powder.
2. Add water and bouillon. Simmer covered 30 to 40 minutes, until the meat is tender and reaches 160°F. Remove meat and set aside. Keep the broth.
3. Add rice and vegetables to the broth. Cover and simmer 20 minutes, until tender.
4. Fold the meat back in. Season with salt and pepper.

W8. Pan-Fried Fish with Flatbread Fish

Serves 2

Ingredients: 2 fish fillets, 1/4 cup flour, 1/2 tsp salt, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, pepper, 2 tbsp oil, 2 flatbreads (recipe 6).

1. Mix flour, salt, garlic powder, and pepper on a plate. Dredge fillets on both sides.
2. Heat oil in a skillet over medium-high heat. Fry fillets 3 to 4 minutes per side until they flake easily and reach 145°F.
3. Warm flatbreads in the same pan. Serve fish on flatbread.

W9. Game Pasta Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 cup dry pasta, 1/2 lb venison or rabbit (cut small), 1/2 can mixed vegetables, 1 bouillon cube, 1 tbsp oil, 1 1/2 cups water, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, salt and pepper.

1. Brown the meat in oil with garlic powder, 5 minutes.
2. Add water and bouillon. Bring to a boil. Simmer 15 minutes, until meat reaches 160°F.
3. Add pasta and vegetables. Simmer 10 to 12 minutes, stirring, until pasta is tender and most liquid is absorbed.
4. Season with salt and pepper.

W10. Game Fried Rice Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 2 cups cooked rice (leftover is fine), 1/2 lb venison or rabbit (small pieces), 1/2 can mixed vegetables, 1 tbsp oil, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1 bouillon cube dissolved in 2 tbsp water, salt and pepper.

1. Cook the meat in oil in a skillet over medium-high heat until it reaches 160°F, about 5 minutes.
2. Add garlic powder and vegetables. Cook 2 minutes.
3. Add rice and bouillon. Stir-fry 3 to 4 minutes until hot. Season.

W11. Game Hash with Potato Flakes Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 lb venison or rabbit (cooked and chopped, or ground), 1 cup potato flakes made with 1 cup water and 1/2 bouillon cube, 1/2 can corn, 1 tbsp oil, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, salt and pepper.

1. Heat oil in a skillet. Cook meat until it reaches 160°F, about 5 minutes.
2. Stir in prepared potato flakes, corn, and garlic powder. Press flat and cook 5 minutes until a crust forms on the bottom.
3. Flip sections and cook 3 more minutes. Season.

W12. Bean and Game Burritos Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/3 lb venison or rabbit (ground or shredded), 1 cup cooked beans, 1 tbsp oil, 1/2 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp cumin, salt, 2 flatbreads, 1/2 cup cooked rice.

1. Cook meat in oil with spices until it reaches 160°F, about 5 minutes. Add beans and mash, adding a little water if dry.
2. Warm flatbreads in a dry skillet.
3. Spread bean filling and rice on each flatbread, roll, and eat.

W13. Game and TVP Taco Filling Main

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/3 cup dry TVP, 1/2 cup hot bouillon broth (1 cube in 1/2 cup water), 1/4 lb ground game, 1 tbsp oil, 1 tsp chili powder, 1/2 tsp cumin, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp salt.

1. Stir TVP into hot broth. Let stand 5 minutes.
2. Brown ground game in oil with spices until it reaches 160°F. Stir in rehydrated TVP and cook 5 minutes.
3. Serve with rice or flatbread.

Preserved and snack recipes

W14. Venison or Rabbit Jerky Preserve

Makes about 1/2 lb jerky

Ingredients: 1 lb lean venison, cut into 1/4-inch strips, 1 tsp salt, 1 tbsp honey, 1/2 tsp garlic powder, 1/2 tsp black pepper, 2 tbsp water.

1. Trim all fat, which spoils quickly. Slice strips about 1/4 inch thick, across the grain.
2. Mix salt, honey, garlic powder, pepper, and water into a marinade. Coat strips and refrigerate 4 to 12 hours.
3. Heat strips to 160°F in the oven or in simmering marinade before drying, following USDA guidance.
4. Dry in a dehydrator at 145°F to 160°F, or in a low oven with the door propped open, until strips are firm and leathery. Cool and store in airtight containers.

W15. Trail Pemmican Bars No-cook

Makes 8 bars

Ingredients: 1/2 cup crushed dried jerky, 1/2 cup rolled oats, 1/4 cup peanut butter, 2 tbsp honey, 2 tbsp dried fruit (chopped).

1. Mix everything until it holds together. Press firmly into a lined pan.
2. Chill and cut into 8 bars. Wrap and store in a cool, dry place.

W16. Cold Tuna and Game Salad No-cook

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1/2 cup cooked and cooled game (thinly sliced jerky works too), 1 can (5 oz) tuna, drained, 1 can (15 oz) beans, drained and rinsed, 1/2 cup corn, 1 tbsp oil, 1 tsp honey (optional), salt and pepper.

1. Combine meat, tuna, beans, and corn in a bowl.
2. Stir in oil, honey, salt, and pepper.
3. Serve on its own or wrapped in flatbread.

Dessert

W17. Fruit Cobbler in a Pot Dessert

Serves 2

Ingredients: 1 can (15 oz) canned fruit with juice, 1 cup flour, 2 tbsp sugar, 1 tsp baking powder, pinch of salt, 1/2 cup water, 1 tbsp oil, 1/4 tsp cinnamon (optional).

1. Pour fruit and juice into a pot. Simmer 5 minutes.
2. Mix flour, sugar, baking powder, and salt. Add oil and water to form a soft dough.
3. Drop spoonfuls over the fruit. Cover and cook on low 15 to 20 minutes, until the topping is cooked through.

Part 7: Safety and Reference

Keep this section with your supplies so you can find it fast.

Safety Reference

- **Carbon monoxide:** Never run a generator, camp stove, grill, or propane heater indoors or in an enclosed space. Install CO detectors with battery backup.
- **Fire:** Keep a fire extinguisher rated for household fires, and check it monthly.
- **First aid kit essentials:** Gauze, adhesive tape, bandages, antiseptic, antibiotic ointment, tweezers, scissors, instant cold packs, a CPR face shield, nitrile gloves, a tourniquet (trained use only), pain reliever, and any personal medications for both of you.

Rotation and Maintenance Schedule

When	What to check
Every 3 months	Test the radio and flashlights. Check battery dates. Rotate food.
Every 6 months	Replace home-stored tap water. Test your water filter. Review medications and refills. Run a power-off drill. Refresh skill practice.
Every 12 months	Review all expiration dates. Update contact lists and documents. Service generators and fire extinguishers. Restock fuel. Renew first aid certifications.

Cooking and Water Quick Reference

Item	Target
Venison, rabbit, squirrel (whole cuts and ground)	160°F
Fish	145°F
Keep meat cold	Below 40°F
Jerky, before drying	160°F
Water treatment (boil)	Rolling boil 1 minute (3 minutes above about 6,500 feet)
Bleach water treatment	8 drops per gallon clear water (16 if cloudy), wait 30 minutes

This guide is general information. Check your local wildlife agency's current regulations, licensing, and safety guidance before hunting, trapping, or fishing. Take first aid and hunter safety training in person where you can.

Appendix A: Recipe Index

Every recipe in this guide, with the page it starts on.

Pantry Recipes (Part 6)

1. Oatmeal Breakfast Bowl 41
2. Pancakes 41
3. Rice Pudding 41
4. Rice and Bean Chili 42
5. Chicken and Rice Skillet 42
6. Skillet Flatbread 42
7. One-Pot Chicken Pasta 43
8. Lentil and Rice Soup 43
9. Tuna Noodle Skillet 43
10. Bean Burritos on Flatbread 44
11. TVP Taco Filling 44
12. Potato and Chicken Chowder 44
13. Fruit Cobbler in a Pot 45
14. Peanut Butter Honey Energy Bars 45
15. Tuna and Bean Salad 45
16. Peanut Butter Honey Wraps 46

Wild Game Recipes (Part 6)

W1. Game Sausage Patties 46
W2. Peanut Butter Honey Oat Bars 46
W3. Venison and Vegetable Stew 47
W4. Lentil and Game Soup 47
W5. Fish Chowder 47
W6. Venison Rice Chili 48
W7. Rabbit and Rice Pilaf 48
W8. Pan-Fried Fish with Flatbread 48
W9. Game Pasta 49
W10. Game Fried Rice 49
W11. Game Hash with Potato Flakes 49
W12. Bean and Game Burritos 50
W13. Game and TVP Taco Filling 50
W14. Venison or Rabbit Jerky 50
W15. Trail Pemmican Bars 51
W16. Cold Tuna and Game Salad 51
W17. Fruit Cobbler in a Pot 51

Appendix B: Diagram Index

Each drawing is followed by a numbered legend that explains every marker.

Figure 1. Field-dressing cuts, viewed from the belly with the animal on its back 28
Figure 2. Skinning a rabbit hung by its hind legs 30
Figure 3. Quartering map of a deer (side view, head on the right) 31
Figure 4. Cutting up a skinned, gutted rabbit (side view, rear on the left) 33
Figure 5. Box trap, side view 35
Figure 6. Snare set, looking down the trail 36
Figure 7. Gutting and filleting a fish (head on the left) 39

Appendix C: Quick-Find for Urgent Topics

Where to look first when time matters.

Medical and safety

Stop heavy bleeding 14
CPR for an adult 14
Burns 14
Hypothermia 14
Heat exhaustion and heatstroke 14
Carbon monoxide safety 52

Water, food, and storage

Treat water (boiling and bleach) 8
Find water outdoors 13
Sample daily meal plan 8
Meat storage methods compared 10
Pressure canning meat 11
Food safety during an outage 10
Rotation and maintenance schedule 52
Make a charcoal water filter 9
Make charcoal at home 9

Field skills

Start a fire 13
Build a shelter 13
Navigation without a compass; if you are lost 23
Signal for help 14
Essential knots 14
Morse code alphabet and numbers 17
Coordinate word code (encode and decode) 25
Read latitude and longitude 18
Read a UTM or MGRS grid 19
Read contour lines 18
Use a compass: parts and bearings 21
Take a compass bearing 22
Find your position (resection) 22

Hunting, trapping, and fishing

Field dress (gut) large game 28
Skin a rabbit or squirrel 30
Quarter large game 31
Make a trap 34
Clean and fillet a fish 39
Safe cooking temperatures for game and fish 39